

STAX Lab Follow-Up Email

Follow-up on the 2022 school lunch grant scoring change

From: The Hon. Dr. Sir Jensen Ahokovi, PhD, MA, BA. <jensen@stax.example>
To: STAX Predoc Team <predocs@stax.example>
Date: Thursday, March 14, 2024 at 3:42 PM
Attach: student_health_wellbeing_survey_extract.csv

Hi team,

Thanks for putting together the school-year panel and the notes. This is very helpful, and I think it may be enough for a first analysis pass.

One more thing: I confirmed that the state changed the modernization grant scoring in 2022. After the change, applications tied to scratch-cooking equipment, cold storage, and healthier serving-line infrastructure appear to have received a clearer priority. That may give us a useful timing change to explore, though I do not want to assume it is a clean policy break without checking the panel.

I also attached a school-year survey extract with aggregate student health and wellbeing measures. Please merge it carefully before using those variables. If the scoring change mattered in practice, I would expect to see something like more schools receiving grants, larger grant amounts, or improvements in lunch participation, healthy-meal scores, and aggregate student health or wellbeing measures after 2022.

Please be cautious with the wellbeing and mental-health-related measures. A referral rate could reflect need, detection, service access, or reporting practice, so treat those checks as exploratory survey signals rather than proof of a mental-health effect.

Could you take a first pass at whether the panel shows anything along those lines? Please use your judgment about the exact comparisons. Pre/post patterns, plots, and some regression-style checks would be useful, but I do not want to force one specification too early.

I mostly want to know whether there is anything promising here, what the first-pass estimates look like, and what we would need to check before taking the result seriously.

Thanks,

The Hon. Dr. Sir Jensen Ahokovi, PhD, MA, BA.